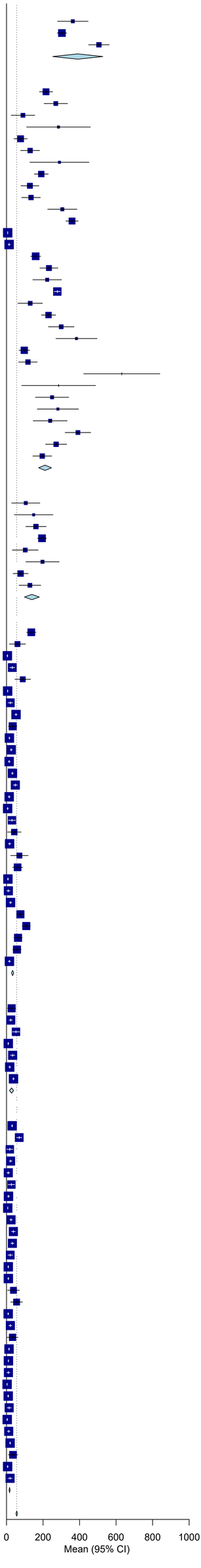
Random model meta-analysis of VEGF levels in healthy adults. Means calculated as standardized overall untransformed mean (MRAW) with 95 % confidence. Sub-groups based on sample system with more than three values: whole blood, serum, activated plasma, EDTA- (including PECT and Edinburgh-plasma), heparin- and citrate-plasma (including, CTAD- and ACD-plasma).

Source	MRAW (95% CI)	n
Whole blood		
Kusumanto et al. (2004)	363.14 [279.22; 447.06]	13
Salven et al. (1999)	303.39 [277.85; 328.94]	56
Werther et al. a) (2002)	506.00 [449.59; 562.41]	24
Total	390.06 [253.14; 526.97]	**93**
Heterogeneity:	χ^2_2 = 41.45 (P < .001), I^2 = 95%	
Serum		
Adams et al. (2000)	216.20 [180.21; 252.20]	63
Azimi−Nezhad et al. (2012)	269.72 [205.43; 334.00]	27
Banks et al. (1998)	90.00 [25.32; 154.68]	4
Banks et al. (1998)	284.50 [109.95; 459.05]	8
Biancotto et al. (2012)	76.90 [40.44; 113.36]	11
Brøndum et al. (2016)	129.27 [77.11; 181.43]	18
Dittadi et al. (2001)	289.90 [128.13; 451.67]	10
George et al. (2000)	190.29 [152.15; 228.43]	74
Guo et al. (2013)	128.09 [78.78; 177.40]	9
Guo et al. (2013)	134.22 [83.09; 185.36]	9
Hetland et al. (2008)	305.52 [225.38; 385.66]	10
Hetland et al. (2008)	358.79 [324.89; 392.70]	306
Krishnan et al. (2014), age group 18−30	6.40 [5.41; 7.39]	31
Krishnan et al. (2014), age group 31−50	14.30 [8.04; 20.56]	30
Larsson et al (2001)	159.70 [132.05; 187.35]	80
Lee et al. (2000)	232.40 [182.92; 281.88]	42
Lopez Yomayuza et al. (2019)	222.70 [143.92; 301.48]	10
Lopez Yomayuza et al. (2019)	278.14 [260.87; 295.41]	10
Lopez Yomayuza et al. (2019)	129.60 [62.20; 197.00]	10
Maloney et al. (1998)	230.00 [190.95; 269.05]	10
McIlhenny et al. (2002)	299.55 [229.60; 369.50]	20
Ranieri et al. (2004)	383.00 [270.30; 495.70]	16
Salgado et al. (2001)	97.20 [68.70; 125.70]	24
Salven et al. (1999)	117.30 [66.45; 168.15]	23
Starlinger et al. (2011)	631.10 [422.66; 839.54]	3
Verheul et al. (1997)	285.18 [82.87; 487.49]	30
Webb et al. (1997)	249.40 [158.46; 340.34]	34
Webb et al. (1997)	281.29 [168.56; 394.03]	6
Webb et al. (1997)	239.16 [146.16; 332.15]	10
Werther et al. a) (2002)	391.00 [320.99; 461.01]	24
Werther et al. b) (2002)	271.66 [213.92; 329.40]	50
Wynendael et al. (1999)	195.71 [144.15; 247.27]	22
Total	211.05 [175.66; 246.43]	**1034**
Heterogeneity:	χ^2_{31} = 2684.72 (P < .001), I^2 = 99%	
Activated citrate plasma		
Banks et al. (1998)	105.38 [28.11; 182.64]	8
Banks et al. (1998)	148.62 [43.05; 254.20]	8
Lopez Yomayuza et al. (2019)	161.10 [105.50; 216.70]	10
Lopez Yomayuza et al. (2019)	194.43 [170.27; 218.60]	10
Lopez Yomayuza et al. (2019)	102.54 [31.90; 173.18]	10
Ranieri et al. (2004)	197.00 [105.86; 288.14]	16
Ranieri et al. (2004)	77.00 [35.84; 118.16]	16
Webb et al. (1997)	127.96 [68.61; 187.31]	6
Total	138.85 [98.11; 179.59]	**84**
Heterogeneity:	χ^2_7 = 29.4 (P < .001), I^2 = 76%	
EDTA-plasma		
Azimi−Nezhad et al. (2012)	135.72 [109.95; 161.48]	27
Banks et al. (1998)	60.00 [15.90; 104.10]	4
Biancotto et al. (2012)	4.70 [1.76; 7.64]	11
Brøndum et al. (2016)	31.46 [17.88; 45.04]	18
Brøndum et al. (2016)	89.01 [46.16; 131.86]	15
Dittadi et al. (2001)	6.10 [3.93; 8.27]	10
Hetland et al. (2008)	20.68 [8.39; 32.96]	10
Hetland et al. (2008)	51.97 [45.28; 58.66]	306
Krishnan et al. (2014), age group 18−30	33.70 [10.55; 56.85]	30
Krishnan et al. (2014), age group 31−50	15.70 [12.36; 19.04]	31
Krishnan et al. (2014), age group 51−64	25.60 [19.37; 31.83]	30
Krishnan et al. (2014), age group 65−85	14.50 [8.67; 20.33]	16
Larsson et al (2001)	32.20 [27.42; 36.98]	80
Lee et al. (2000)	48.20 [37.71; 58.69]	42
McIlhenny et al. (2002)	14.57 [8.67; 20.48]	20
Schlingemann et al. (2013)	6.10 [2.08; 10.12]	21
Starlinger et al. (2011)	29.60 [10.59; 48.61]	3
Verheul et al. (1997)	42.40 [4.77; 80.03]	30
Walz et al. (2016)	16.80 [9.75; 23.85]	6
Walz et al. (2016)	70.54 [22.61; 118.47]	6
Walz et al. (2016)	60.60 [33.44; 87.76]	8
Walz et al. (2016)	7.67 [3.96; 11.38]	2
Walz et al. (2016)	10.08 [0.87; 19.29]	2
Walz et al. (2016)	21.90 [15.66; 28.14]	8
Webb et al. (1997)	76.10 [55.13; 97.07]	34
Webb et al. (1997)	108.30 [85.76; 130.84]	20
Werther et al. a) (2002)	63.00 [40.20; 85.80]	24
Werther et al. b) (2002)	57.10 [34.36; 79.84]	50
Wynendael et al. (1999)	15.91 [9.46; 22.36]	22
Total	33.30 [27.20; 39.40]	**886**
Heterogeneity:	χ^2_{28} = 623.66 (P < .001), I^2 = 96%	
Heparin-plasma		
Banks et al. (1998)	28.00 [5.46; 50.54]	4
Biancotto et al. (2012)	23.00 [14.38; 31.62]	11
Brøndum et al. (2016)	51.78 [32.10; 71.45]	15
Guo et al. (2013)	9.64 [6.35; 12.93]	9
Hetland et al. (2008)	33.66 [22.39; 44.94]	10
Krishnan et al. (2014), age group 18−30	17.40 [12.18; 22.62]	30
Maloney et al. (1998)	38.20 [33.43; 42.97]	10
Total	27.60 [16.28; 38.93]	**89**
Heterogeneity:	χ^2_6 = 111.48 (P < .001), I^2 = 95%	
Citrate-plasma		
Adams et al. (2000)	30.77 [26.44; 35.09]	63
Azimi−Nezhad et al. (2012)	69.57 [55.41; 83.73]	27
Banks et al. (1998)	18.00 [1.34; 34.66]	4
Banks et al. (1998)	22.14 [14.73; 29.55]	8
Biancotto et al. (2012)	9.70 [2.06; 17.34]	11
Dittadi et al. (2001)	26.70 [8.48; 44.92]	10
Dittadi et al. (2001)	10.70 [4.94; 16.46]	10
George et al. (2000)	6.72 [5.84; 7.59]	113
Hetland et al. (2008)	24.69 [17.24; 32.14]	10
Hormbrey et al. (2002)	37.40 [27.42; 47.38]	8
Hormbrey et al. (2002)	32.14 [23.76; 40.52]	8
Krishnan et al. (2014), age group 18−30	20.30 [7.88; 32.72]	30
Krishnan et al. (2014), age group 31−50	9.70 [7.24; 12.16]	31
Kusumanto et al. (2004)	9.95 [6.23; 13.66]	13
Lopez Yomayuza et al. (2019)	38.00 [5.58; 70.42]	10
Lopez Yomayuza et al. (2019)	55.09 [22.98; 87.20]	10
Lopez Yomayuza et al. (2019)	9.17 [5.22; 13.11]	10
Ranieri et al. (2004)	21.00 [12.67; 29.33]	16
Ranieri et al. (2004)	33.00 [3.11; 62.89]	16
Salgado et al. (2001)	13.70 [10.02; 17.38]	24
Schlingemann et al. (2013)	10.40 [8.30; 12.50]	21
Starlinger et al. (2011)	10.40 [2.37; 18.43]	3
Starlinger et al. (2011)	3.13 [1.66; 4.60]	13
Starlinger et al. (2011)	9.28 [5.00; 13.56]	10
Starlinger et al. (2011)	14.30 [2.87; 25.73]	3
Walz et al. (2016)	3.80 [0.53; 7.07]	2
Walz et al. (2016)	11.96 [4.59; 19.33]	2
Walz et al. (2016)	19.60 [15.51; 23.69]	8
Webb et al. (1997)	35.53 [9.78; 61.28]	6
Wynendael et al. (1999)	6.05 [2.73; 9.36]	22
Wynendael et al. (1999)	19.47 [8.25; 30.69]	10
Total	16.70 [13.82; 19.57]	**532**
Heterogeneity:	χ^2_{30} = 427.04 (P < .001), I^2 = 93%	
Total	55.70 [51.66; 59.75]	**2718**
Heterogeneity:	χ^2_{109} = 5188.18 (P < .001), I^2 = 98%	
Test for subgroup differences:	χ^2_5 = 196.12 (P < .001)